

Chapter 27 — Biconsonantal / Geminate Disambiguation Drill

BBH Chapters 25 & 27 · Niphal and Hiphil Weak Verbs

For each form: (1) identify the stem (Niphal or Hiphil); (2) parse — conjugation, PGN; (3) identify the weak class (Biconsonantal or Geminate); (4) give the root and translate. Biconsonantal and Geminate forms are vocally identical — root knowledge is required. Answer key is on the last page.

Biconsonantal (II-ו/י): medial vowel letter ו or י retained in stem (e.g. וּכְנַח, שָׁמַח, בָּרַח, יָדַח). Geminate (R2=R3): same consonant at R2 and R3; no medial vowel letter (e.g. מָחַח, בָּבַב, טָטַט). Both classes share: Niphal perfect נָ (qamets); Hiphil perfect הָ (tsere); Hiphil imperfect יָ (qamets); Hiphil imperative הָ (qamets); Hiphil participle מְ (tsere).

Part A — Niphal: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Niphal. Identify whether each is Biconsonantal (medial ו/י) or Geminate (R2=R3). The prefix vowel pattern (נָ in perfect; יָ in imperfect) is identical for both classes.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
1	וּכְנַח	Gen 41:32	"the thing is ___ by God"					
2	וּבְבַב	1 Kgs 7:24	"the gourds ___ it, ten to a					
3	וּכְנַח	Psa 93:2	"your throne ___ from of old"					
4	וּבְבַב	Num 21:4	"they traveled ___ Mount Edom"					
5	וּכְנַח	Psa 57:8	"my heart is ___, O God"					
6	וּבְבַב	Num 34:4	"your border ___ from the					
7	וּבְבַב	Lam 3:40	"let us examine and ___ to the					
8	וּכְנַח	1 Sam 3:12	"when I ___ what I have					

Part B — Hiphil: Biconsonantal vs. Geminate

All forms are Hiphil. Hiphil prefix patterns: הָ (perfect) · יָ (imperfect) · הָ (imperative) · מְ (participle). These are identical for Biconsonantal and Geminate — root knowledge is the only distinguisher.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
9	הִקְיִם	Gen 6:18	"I will ___ my covenant with					
10	הִסְבֵּ	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
11	הִקְיִם	Deut 18:15	"the LORD will ___ a prophet"					
12	הִסְבֵּ	Eccl 1:6	"the wind ___ to the south"					
13	הִקְיִם	Deut 27:26	"___ the words of this law"					
14	הִסְבֵּ	2 Sam 2:22	"___ from following me"					
15	הִקְיִם	1 Sam 2:8	"He ___ the poor from the dust"					
16	הִסְבֵּ	Jer 21:4	"I am turning around the					

Part C — Mixed: Stem and Class Both Unknown

Identify both the stem (Niphal/Hiphal/Qal/Hophal) and the class. Part C includes Qal and Hophal forms as distractors — not every Biconsonantal form is Niphal or Hiphil.

#	Form	Ref	Context	Stem	Conjugation	PGN	Class	Root
17	נָמוּג	Isa 14:31	"all Philistia ____"					
18	הִמָּטוּ	Deu 1:28	"our brothers ____ our hearts"					
19	יָרֵם	Isa 52:13	"my servant shall be high and					
20	יָרֵם	Psa 99:2	"great is the LORD, ____ above					
21	הִרָּיִם	Gen 14:22	"I have ____ my hand to the					
22	הוֹרָם	Lev 4:10	"just as it is ____ from the peace					
23	יָשׁוּב	Hos 14:8	"they ____ in the shade"					
24	יִשָּׁב	Lam 1:11	"all her people ____ to find					

Reflection Questions

- Items 1 (נָמוּג) and 2 (בָּסַג) have the same נ prefix. What is the only reliable way to identify נָמוּג as Biconsonantal (root נ־מ־ג) and בָּסַג as Geminate (root ס־ב־ג)?
- Items 9 (מִי־קָה) and 10 (בָּסַה) both have ה־ prefix (tsere). One retains a medial vowel letter; the other shows a contracted stem. Describe precisely what the medial position of each form looks like and how that reflects the root structure.
- Items 11 (מִי־קָי) and 12 (בָּסַי) are both Hiphil imperfect 3ms. You encounter an unknown form יִדְּלִי. What question must you ask to determine if it is Biconsonantal or Geminate?
- Items 19 (מִי־רָי) and 21 (מִי־רָה) come from the same root (מ־ר־י) but differ in stem. What vowel under R2 distinguishes the Niphal imperfect from the Hiphil perfect?
- Item 22 (מִי־רָה) was classified as Hophal. How does the Hophal Biconsonantal prefix (י־ה־) differ from Niphal (נ־) and Hiphil (ה־), and what does it tell you about the semantics?

Answer Key

#	Form	Stem	Answer
1	נָכֵן	Niphal	Perfect/Ptc · 3ms/ms · Biconsonantal · כּוּן — "is established / firm" — נָ, prefix (qamets); medial ו vowel
2	נָסַב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "encircled / went around" — נָ, prefix (qamets); R2=R3=ב = Geminate;
3	יָכֵן	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · כּוּן — "is established" — יָ, + dagesh in כּ + holem-vav = Niphal
4	יָסַב	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "went around" — יָ, + dagesh in ס (R2=R3 doubled) + holem =
5	הָכֵן	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · כּוּן — "is ready / prepared" — הָ, + dagesh + holem-vav = Niphal
6	הָסַב	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "turned / went around" — הָ, + dagesh in ס (R2=R3) + holem = Niphal
7	נָשׁוּב	Niphal	Cohortative · 1cp · Biconsonantal · שׁוּב — "let us return" — נָ, prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
8	נָתַם	Niphal	Inf. Const. · — · Geminate · תַּמֵּת — "to be completed / finished" — נָ, prefix + holem = Niphal Geminate
9	הִקִּים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · קִים — "established / raised up" — הָ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; medial ו vowel
10	הִסַּב	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "turned aside" — הָ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; no medial vowel letter,
11	יִקִּים	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · קִים — "will raise up" — יָ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil Biconsonantal
12	יִסַּב	Hiphil	Imperfect · 3ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "causes to go around / turns" — יָ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil; no
13	הִקֵּם	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Biconsonantal · קִים — "raise up! / confirm!" — הָ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative;
14	הִסֵּב	Hiphil	Imperative · 2ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "turn aside!" — הָ, prefix (qamets) = Hiphil imperative; same vowels
15	מִקִּים	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Biconsonantal · קִים — "one who raises up" — מָ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; medial ו
16	מִסַּב	Hiphil	Participle · ms · Geminate · סַבֵּס — "turning / surrounding" — מָ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil participle; no
17	נָמוּג	Niphal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · גִּוַּם — "melted / dissolved" — נָ, prefix + medial ו = Niphal Biconsonantal;
18	הִמָּסָא	Hiphil	Perfect · 3cp · Geminate · סָסַם — "caused to melt" — הָ, prefix (tsere) = Hiphil; R2=R3=ס = Geminate;
19	יִרָם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · רוּם — "will be exalted / lifted up" — יָ, prefix + qibbutz under R2
20	יָרַם	Niphal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · רוּם — "is exalted / high" — יָ, prefix + holem under R2 = Niphal
21	הִרִים	Hiphil	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · רוּם — "lifted up / swore an oath" — הָ, prefix (tsere) + chiriq-yod = Hiphil
22	הוֹרָם	Hophal	Perfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · רוּם — "was lifted off / removed" — הוּ, prefix (holem-vav) = Hophal
23	יָשׁוּב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · שׁוּב — "will dwell / return" — Qal Biconsonantal — no Niphal נ or Hiphil
24	יָשַׁב	Qal	Imperfect · 3ms · Biconsonantal · שׁוּב — "returned / went around" — Qal Biconsonantal; holem vowel